PRE-SEED · $1M · 2026

The Crypto Lending Platform That *Explains Itself.*

Crypto-collateralized lending infrastructure for credit unions — with AI-powered underwriting guidance built in. Pre-Seed · $1M · 2026

140M	$2.2T	$0
CU MEMBERS IN THE US	CU ASSETS UNDER MANAGEMENT	B2B CRYPTO LENDING INFRASTRUCTURE

SCROLL

01 · PROBLEM

Credit unions are *locked out* of crypto lending.

140 million Americans trust their credit union over any bank. But when those members want to unlock liquidity from their Bitcoin or Ethereum holdings, they're forced to go to D2C lenders like Nexo or Ledn — or sell, triggering a taxable event.

Credit unions want to serve these members. The regulatory complexity is the barrier — not the appetite.

01 No compliant crypto lending infrastructure exists for NCUA-regulated institutions

02 D2C competitors (Nexo, Ledn, SALT) aren't B2B — they compete with CUs, not serve them

03 Younger members with crypto assets are migrating to fintech — CUs are losing them

04 No risk assessment model purpose-built for crypto collateral under NCUA guidelines exists

05 BitGo, Plaid, and KYC/AML integration requires months of compliance work per institution

liquidity at 8–12% APR. Real-time LTV monitoring with automated margin calls.

purpose-built for crypto collateral. AI-powered guidance layer live — members receive plain-language borrowing insights directly from their DACS profile.

PATENT PENDING

within the CU's structure. Aetherum is the software layer only — we never touch member assets.

04 · Compliance

Plaid + Sardine Integration

Plaid Check (CRA bundle) approved and live across 6 core products. Sardine KYC/AML/fraud under MSA negotiation. Compliance-first architecture from day one.

05 · Compliance

ERC-3643 On-Chain Identity

Clean-room implementation of three ERC-3643 compliance modules — jurisdiction gating, collateral LTV verification, and CU member identity attestation. Built on the T-REX standard. Deployed on Sepolia testnet.

PATENT PENDING

06 · Privacy

Privacy-Preserving Underwriting (FHE-DACS)

Member financial data is encrypted before the risk assessment process begins. Lending decisions are computed without exposing raw inputs at any step — ever. Patent-pending architecture purpose-built for NCUA-regulated institutions.

PATENT PENDING

07 · Yield

Staking Module

Members can stake supported digital assets directly through the platform —

08 · Tax Intelligence

Tax-Position Score & Collateral Optimizer (TPSOE™)

The TPSOE engine scores the tax

09 · Member Intelligence

Member Crypto Insights

Real-time visibility into the digital assets your members already own — before

03 · MARKET

A massive, *unserved* market.

The credit union ecosystem is one of the largest financial networks in the US — and the last major institutional channel without crypto lending infrastructure.

140M	5,000+	$1.2M
CREDIT UNION MEMBERS IN THE UNITED STATES	CREDIT UNIONS REACHABLE	TARGET ARR AT 10 CUS × 100 LOANS/MONTH

DACS™	5 provisionals filed	— Nine-pillar risk model, live gauge wired to API. Includes TPSOE as sixth pillar, CUMember as seventh, FHE-DACS as eighth, and DACS-LTV as ninth.	PATENT PENDING
TPSOE™	Second provisional filed	— Tax-Position Score & Collateral Optimizer ranks pledge assets by embedded tax liability. No B2B competitor offers this to institutions.	PATENT PENDING
FHE-DACS	Fourth provisional filed — March 2026	— Homomorphic encryption layer for DACS risk assessment. Member financial data remains encrypted throughout the entire underwriting decisioning process.	PATENT PENDING
DACS-LTV™	Fifth provisional filed — April 2026	— Automated on-chain collateral LTV attestation triggered by DACS scoring. Collateral value and loan balance set directly on the AetherumCollateralLTVModule in real time.	PATENT PENDING
ECOSYSTEM ADVISOR	Steve Salzer, SVP & General Counsel at Velera — Board Advisor to Aetherum.	Chairs the Board of Ongoing Operations LLC and sits on the NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee and CUNA Payments Subcommittee.	
SMART REVIEW	Shipped — live in	— AI-powered underwriting guidance live in production, zero additional friction in the loan flow. Members receive a plain-language borrowing assessment automatically at the point of	

Revenue is tied directly to loan volume — meaning we grow as our credit union partners grow. The SaaS license layer adds predictable recurring revenue at scale.

ARR TARGET

$1K/loan × 100 loans/mo × 10 CUs = $1.2M ARR

Tax Intelligence add-on layer creates additional recurring revenue per CU partner.

ERC-3643 module licensing creates a second revenue surface independent of loan volume.

Platform Fees

$500–$1,500 per loan originated. Primary revenue driver tied to volume.

Transaction Fees

0.5–1% on crypto collateral transactions processed through the platform.

10%

SaaS License

$50K–$150K/year for large credit unions. Predictable ARR layer at scale.

New

Tax Intelligence Module

$10K–25K/year per credit union as a premium add-on. Tells members not just what they can borrow — but which assets to pledge and how much they save in taxes by borrowing instead of selling. No B2B competitor offers this to institutions.

New

ERC-3643 Compliance Layer

Per-attestation module licensing fees. Any RWA issuer requiring US

Built by operators.
Advised by the ecosystem.

John Bailey

FOUNDER & CEO

20+ years in technical recruiting with placements at Google, Spotify, and Goldman Sachs. Previously co-founded Thorium Data (Data Catalog). Building Aetherum full-time since early 2025, managing all product, BD, fundraising, and technical implementation.

Steve Salzer

BOARD ADVISOR · SVP, VELERA

SVP, Enterprise Risk Office & General Counsel at Velera since 2017. Chairs the Board of Managers at Ongoing Operations LLC. Sits on the NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee and CUNA Payments Subcommittee. JD, University of Chicago Law School.

Rahul Goel

ADVISOR · JP MORGAN / UBER

Cybersecurity and financial infrastructure expertise from senior roles at JP Morgan and Uber, including involvement with Meta's Novi digital wallet. Advises on platform security architecture and institutional trust.

Saiprasad Raut

ADVISOR · WORLDPAY / VANAR

Head of Payments Infrastructure at Vanar, formerly Worldpay. Deep payments and blockchain infrastructure expertise guiding Aetherum's settlement and custody architecture.

Closing a *$1M Pre-Seed* Round.

We're in the final stretch of closing our pre-seed round. Proceeds go toward closing the first two credit union pilots, completing platform development, and bringing on a CTO.

Capital deploys us to first 3 credit union pilots — reducing market risk and proving the explanation layer at scale.

ROUND SIZE	$1,000,000
INSTRUMENT	Post-Money SAFE
VALUATION CAP	$10M Post-Money
DISCOUNT	20%
TIMELINE	Closing April 25, 2026

REQUEST A DEMO

Let's talk.

20 minutes. We'll walk through the platform live and answer any diligence questions.

BOOK A CALL

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